

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - September 16, 2026 (Part 1)

Compiled summary for Wednesday, September 16, 2026 - Part 1 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio work after the September 15 documentation state, verifying the United States Eastern date, refreshing the project snapshot, extracting and studying all thirty-eight pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs, refining landing-page hero device hover behavior, updating Featured Case Studies card imagery and platform/device divider geometry, aligning the Alla Vostra project-page navigation to the landing-page navbar, adding ordered actionable section links for Demo, Product, and UI / UX, preserving responsive navbar margins and two-row behavior, removing row-leading dividers at narrow widths, centering the single Alla Vostra hero device in narrow and portrait layouts, reorganizing the Overview promo screenshots into one horizontal row with responsive placement, validating TypeScript and Next.js build health, restoring the Next.js dev route reference after the build, documenting committed source state 439d885, and generating the September 16 Part 1 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_september15.pdf` and after the September 15 documentation state. The source state reviewed for this record is 439d885039e2a4a3ecaeeb4c87b32c2c166041ca on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated, titled Aligned Alla Vostra navigation and overview presentation. The September 16 source work in scope is represented by commits c5814cc Refined landing hero and case study cards and 439d885 Aligned Alla Vostra navigation and overview presentation. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, production publish, source commit, push, or public deployment was performed during this PDF-generation pass. The local documentation delta created before this PDF was the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` file; this PDF is the new September 16 Part 1 root-level documentation artifact requested by the user.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date with TZ=America/New_York date from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio`, which reported Wednesday, September 16, 2026 at 7:13 AM EDT with UTC offset -0400. The worklog therefore uses September 16, 2026 and the requested Part 1 suffix.
- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the Portfolio convention that the current source snapshot is refreshed before session documentation.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` for the current source tree, public image and PDF inventories, package scripts, git context, route structure, generated-cache policy, source dumps, and standing local workflow notes.
- Extracted and studied all thirty-eight pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext: the July 11, 14, 15 Part 1, 15 Part 2, 16, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30, and 31 records; the August 1 Parts 1-3, August 3, 4, 5, 6, 10 Parts 1-2, 11, 12 Parts 1-2, 14, 16, and 24 records; and the September 7, September 8, September 8 Part 2, September 9, September 11, September 12 Part 1, September 12 Part 2, and September 15 records.
- Compared the complete PDF series for title cadence, root-level filename conventions, same-day part suffixes, opening-summary density, source-material language, baseline and goal framing, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation wording, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, and output-artifact closure.

- Checked pdfinfo and pdffonts on the latest September 15 and September 12 Part 2 baselines. The accepted output convention remains US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, unencrypted output, and Codex author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Reviewed git history and current state through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git status --short --branch, git rev-parse HEAD, git branch -vv, and current validation output. Confirmed main points at 439d885 and tracks origin/main before this documentation artifact was generated.
- Reviewed the September 16 source commits in scope: c5814cc Refined landing hero and case study cards, and 439d885 Aligned Alla Vostra navigation and overview presentation.
- Reviewed the implementation files carrying the September 16 work: app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/globals.css, app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx, app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, next-env.d.ts, and the refreshed project snapshot.

Baseline Status Before September 16 Work

- The September 15 state had introduced the About Dev route, landing profile navigation, fixed About Dev profile-bubble sizing, My Core Beliefs circular formation, updated Featured Case Studies quantities, and measured platform/device dividers on case-study cards.
- The landing hero device frames still needed the same light-up and slight-magnification behavior as the profile photo bubble when users hovered or focused the phone and tablet previews.
- The Alla Vostra Featured Case Studies card still showed three separate screenshots instead of the main Overview feature image from the Alla Vostra project page.
- The case-study card platform/device grid needed more exact visual parity: horizontal divider thickness and breathing room needed to match the vertical dividers, the Prahlin.dev card needed a DEVICE row with PHONE, TABLET, and DESK labels, and stray vertical dividers or empty line segments needed to be removed.
- The Alla Vostra project page still used its older local project nav instead of the landing-page MainNavBar composition, and its section links did not yet reflect the accepted Overview, Demo, Scope, Product, UI / UX, Stack, and Contact top-to-bottom order.
- During narrower views, the expanded Alla Vostra navbar could become cramped, risk a three-row link layout, or expose separator characters at the start of a wrapped row. The nav also needed to preserve landing-page-like top spacing and left/right margins while the viewport stretched.
- In narrow and portrait Alla Vostra hero layouts, the single visible hero device was slightly right of center because the rotated device used a top-centered transform origin.
- The Overview section still split its four smaller promo screenshots into two pairs inside the release grids. The requested layout was one running horizontal strip: below both release grids when the release grids sit two per row, and between App Store and Google Play when the release grids stack one per row.

Goals for September 16 Part 1

- Make the landing hero phone and tablet frames light up and magnify slightly on hover or keyboard focus in the same spirit as the existing profile-photo bubble interaction.
- Replace the Alla Vostra case-study card screenshot set with the main Overview feature image, and align all case-study card platform/device grids around matching horizontal and vertical divider weights, spacing, labels, and empty-line behavior.

- Reuse the shared landing-page MainNavBar on the Alla Vostra project page while preserving the page-specific link names, order, anchors, responsive two-row behavior, top spacing, and protected viewport margins.
- Rename and consolidate project-page nav items into Demo, Product, and UI / UX, add actionable Core Features/Product behavior, and keep legacy UI Foundations and UX Product Flow hashes synchronized to the correct tab view.
- Prevent nav dividers from appearing as the left-most visible character in any responsive row, especially when Scope begins the lower row in the two-row layout.
- Center the single visible Alla Vostra hero device and screenshot in narrow and portrait layouts without introducing horizontal overflow.
- Move the four smaller Overview promo screenshots into one non-wrapping horizontal row, placing that row below both release grids for the two-grids-per-row layout and between the App Store and Google Play grids for the one-grid-per-row layout.
- Validate TypeScript, production build output, route generation, responsive browser geometry where layout precision matters, and Next.js generated route-import cleanup before producing the PDF.

Work Completed - Landing Hero and Case Study Cards

- Added light-up hover and focus-visible behavior to the landing hero phone and tablet shells by sharing the profile-bubble style language: a slight upward shift, a 1.02 scale factor, brighter/saturated rendering, and green-tinted drop-shadow emphasis.
- Kept the interaction scoped to the device shells themselves so the existing hero composition, profile orbit, device depth ordering, and landing copy layout remain intact.
- Swapped the Alla Vostra case-study card media from a three-screenshot strip to the main Overview feature image, matching the user's request for the card to show the primary Overview photo rather than multiple smaller frames.
- Adjusted case-study card divider treatment so horizontal divider thickness visually matches the vertical dividers and gains a little additional vertical space above and below it.
- Added DEVICE support to the PrahL.dev case-study card and populated it with PHONE, TABLET, and DESK labels, using DESK after the user clarified that COMP should read as DESK.
- Restored and tuned the PrahL.dev horizontal divider after review so the card mirrors the platform/device grid language used by the other project cards.
- Removed the unwanted vertical divider segment that rose above the TABLET/DESK horizontal divider, while preserving the intended divider structure around labeled platform/device cells.
- Standardized vertical spacing above and below the DEVICE/PLATFORM grid, first matching PrahL.dev to the accepted values and then matching the other three cards to that same spacing system.
- Closed the empty vertical gap between the DESK vertical divider and the PrahL.dev horizontal divider so the divider grid reads as one continuous, intentional structure.

Work Completed - Alla Vostra Navigation

- Extended MainNavBar so it accepts a custom aria-label and item list while preserving the existing context-based home/about behavior for other pages.
- Replaced the Alla Vostra project page's older local nav markup with the shared MainNavBar wrapped in project-nav-frame, bringing the page navigation into visual alignment with the landing-page nav while keeping page-specific links.

- Built the Alla Vostra nav item list as Prahlin.dev, Overview, Demo, Scope, Product, UI / UX, Stack, and Contact, matching the project page's top-to-bottom section order and the final user-approved label names.
- Renamed the earlier Flow, Interactive Demo, Core Features, and UI Foundations / UX Product Flow language into the accepted Demo, Product, and UI / UX navbar copy.
- Added id='core-features' to the Core Features/Product section so the Product nav link scrolls to the correct section instead of being a non-actionable label.
- Kept UI / UX anchored to the product-flow section and added hash synchronization in ProductFlowSwitcher so legacy #ui-foundations and #ux-product-flow deep links still select the correct UI or UX view.
- Removed the leftmost divider before Overview in the Alla Vostra nav while preserving the rest of the divider system and preventing divider removal during narrow responsive stretching.
- Added Alla Vostra-specific responsive nav CSS to keep the page in a two-row layout before it becomes cramped, allow more than one project-section link in the top row, and avoid a three-row link stack.
- Protected the nav's left and right margins and top-edge spacing during viewport stretching, matching the landing-page shell behavior instead of letting the project nav hug the screen edge.
- Hid the row-leading separator in every two-row breakpoint, including the very narrow override that re-enabled internal separators, so Scope is the leftmost visible item when the lower row starts.

Work Completed - Alla Vostra Hero and Overview

- Matched the vertical space above the <- Case Studies link in the Alla Vostra hero to the space below it so the back-link rhythm reads balanced against the hero title block.
- Re-centered the lone Alla Vostra hero device in narrow and portrait layouts by rotating the mobile hero device around its own center instead of the top edge, eliminating the measured rightward drift in the screenshot's visual bounds.
- Confirmed the single-device layout centers cleanly from 720px down to 320px wide, with no horizontal overflow and with the side devices intentionally hidden in the narrow hero composition.
- Combined the four smaller Overview promo screenshots into overviewPromoScreenshots so the section renders a single source-driven promo strip rather than two duplicate per-release image pairs.
- Placed the promo strip between the App Store and Google Play release blocks in the DOM, then used grid placement to make it span below both release grids when the release area uses two columns.
- Added stacked-layout rules for phone-width and portrait tablet views so the same one-row promo strip appears between the App Store and Google Play release grids when the releases become one grid per row.
- Forced the overview promo strip to repeat(4, minmax(0, 1fr)) at all tested widths, keeping all four images in one running horizontal row rather than wrapping into two rows.
- Updated the image size hint for the four-up promo row so the browser can choose appropriately sized assets when the row compresses on phone-width screens.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed during this documentation pass with tsc --noEmit.

- npm run build passed during this documentation pass with Next.js 16.2.10, Turbopack compilation, TypeScript, page-data collection, and seven static app routes generated successfully.
- The build route list included /, /_not-found, /aboutdev, /articles, /projects/alla-vostra, and /projects/cinerific.
- Restored next-env.d.ts from the generated production route reference back to import `"./next/dev/types/routes.d.ts"` after npm run build rewrote it.
- Browser measurements during the source session confirmed the Alla Vostra nav lower row begins with Scope and hides the row-leading separator across 1180, 1100, 980, 720, 600, 560, 430, 380, 340, and 320px widths.
- Browser measurements during the source session confirmed the Alla Vostra single hero device and screenshot centerline matched the showcase center at 720, 600, 560, 430, 390, 360, 340, and 320px widths, with zero horizontal overflow.
- Browser measurements during the source session confirmed the Overview promo strip contains four figures sharing one top coordinate, below both release grids in two-column mode and between the release grids in portrait or phone stacked mode.
- Reviewed git status after validation. Before PDF generation, next-env.d.ts had no remaining diff and the only tracked delta was the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - added custom MainNavBar item and aria-label support, updated Alla Vostra card media behavior, and preserved shared nav row rendering for the landing page and project pages.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - refined case-study platform/device grid rendering, divider measurement, Prahlin.dev DEVICE labels, and empty-divider behavior.
- app/globals.css - added landing device hover lighting, case-card divider/spacing polish, Alla Vostra nav frame and responsive nav rules, protected project nav margins, hero-device centering, and overview promo-strip placement.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx - replaced the local project nav with MainNavBar, defined the page-specific nav links, added the Core Features/Product anchor, and consolidated four promo screenshots into one Overview strip.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - added hash synchronization for legacy UI Foundations and UX Product Flow deep links.
- next-env.d.ts - temporarily changed by npm run build and restored to the repository's dev route import convention before PDF generation.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through `./read_project.sh` for this September 16 Part 1 documentation pass.
- portfolio_worklog_september16_part1.pdf - generated as this new root-level dated Portfolio documentation artifact.

Follow-Up Context

- The Alla Vostra project nav now intentionally uses the shared landing-page nav component. Future nav edits should preserve the custom item list, page-section order, aria-label, two-row responsive behavior, and hidden row-leading separator.

- The accepted Alla Vostra nav labels are Overview, Demo, Scope, Product, UI / UX, Stack, and Contact. UI / UX intentionally points to the combined product-flow section rather than separate top-nav links for UI Foundations and UX Product Flow.
- Legacy #ui-foundations and #ux-product-flow hashes still matter for deep links; ProductFlowSwitcher now maps those hashes to the corresponding view.
- The landing hero device hover treatment is intentionally aligned with the profile-photo bubble: small scale, slight lift, and green glow without changing the wider hero composition.
- The Prahlin.dev case-study card now includes PHONE, TABLET, and DESK under DEVICE. Do not revert DESK back to COMP unless the user explicitly asks.
- The Overview promo screenshots are intentionally one row at every responsive mode. In two-release-column mode the strip spans below both grids; in portrait or phone stacked mode it sits between App Store and Google Play.
- The single Alla Vostra hero device is centered through transform-origin: center center in the narrow device rule. Future rotation or origin changes should be checked against the measured visual center, not only the unrotated layout box.
- The project remains on the established Portfolio workflow: local implementation and verification first, with public deployment or Hostinger synchronization only when the user explicitly asks for it.

Output Artifact

- Generated: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_september16_part1.pdf
- Companion sync file: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt
- Source state reviewed: 439d885039e2a4a3ecaeeb4c87b32c2c166041ca on main, matching origin/main before PDF generation.
- Naming follows the user's requested same-day part convention: portfolio_worklog_september16_part1.pdf, even though no earlier September 16 Portfolio PDF existed before this artifact.
- The document records the landing hero and case-study-card refinements, Alla Vostra navigation alignment, responsive divider behavior, single-device hero centering, Overview promo-strip reorganization, validation, committed source context, refreshed snapshot, and documentation work in the established Prahlin Portfolio format.
- This worklog closes the September 16 Part 1 documentation pass. No source commit, push, deployment, public publish, or Hostinger synchronization was performed as part of generating the PDF.